

Product Spec: Mobile Instant Transfer

Meridian Commercial Bank - Internal Document

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Overview

Instant Transfer lets customers send money to another Meridian customer using just a phone number or email address, with funds available to the recipient within seconds rather than the 1-3 business days typical of standard transfers.

Goals

- Enable peer-to-peer transfers that settle in under 10 seconds for Meridian-to-Meridian transfers.
- Support transfer limits configurable per customer risk tier.
- Provide clear, real-time status (sent, received, failed) in the mobile app.

Non-Goals

- Cross-bank instant transfers (out of scope for this version; routed through standard ACH rails instead).
- Business-to-business transfers (covered separately by SPEC-business-loan-portal's disbursement flow for loan-related payments only).

Requirements

1. Sender selects a recipient by phone/email; the app resolves this to a Meridian account via the Recipient Lookup service (opt-in only; customers must have registered a phone/email for lookup).
2. Sender enters an amount, subject to the customer's daily instant-transfer limit (default \$2,500/day, configurable per risk tier by Fraud Operations).
3. Transfer request is screened by the fraud scoring engine in real time (target: under 500ms) before funds move.
4. On approval, funds are moved via the Core Banking Integration Layer's synchronous Ledger Adapter path (not the Balance Cache) to guarantee consistency for both sender and recipient balances.
5. Both parties receive a push notification on completion.
6. Failed transfers (fraud hold, insufficient funds, recipient not found) return a specific, customer-readable error reason.

Dependencies

- Core Banking Integration Layer (synchronous ledger path) - see ARCH-core-banking-integration.
- Fraud scoring engine - see RB-card-fraud-alert-triage for the underlying fraud alert triage process this feature's scoring feeds into.

Open Questions

- Should recipients without the Meridian app be able to claim a transfer via a web link? Deferred to v2.
- Should instant transfer limits stack with existing ACH transfer limits or be tracked independently? Currently independent; revisit after 90 days of production data.